



# Institutional AI governance frameworks: map NIST AI RMF, NIST AI 800-1, and institutional policies into a compliance checklist

Computer

Basic-needs student support hub: build a resource navigator mapping food, housing, healthcare, and emergency aid by campus department

Computer

How do these modules protect student privacy

What data do these modules share with staff

How does the system handle liability risks

These modules should follow one core rule: **discover privately; share deliberately; act through the accountable office**. Semester can make help easier to find and coordinate, but it should minimize sensitive data, keep staff access purpose-bound, and never convert a student's request for help into a hidden risk score.

Under FERPA, an institution may disclose education-record information to school officials with a defined legitimate educational interest, but access is not automatic or unlimited; institutions need written criteria and must limit use to the stated institutional purpose. Contractors can operate as school officials only under the institution's direct control and subject to purpose and redisclosure restrictions. [<sup>11</sup> <sup>12</sup>]

## Privacy by module

### Transfer Transition Hub

The hub should let a student plan privately before sharing anything with an advisor, evaluator, or registrar.

| Data type                                   | Default state      | When staff can access                                                             | Staff should not receive                                        |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Transfer timeline, tasks, goals             | Private to student | Student explicitly shares, or approved advising workflow requires a selected item | Private notes, unrelated plans, AI conversations                |
| Prior-course list and unofficial transcript | Private, encrypted | Student submits/shares to designated transfer evaluator or advisor                | Broad access by faculty, clubs, employers, or unrelated offices |
| Syllabi and course documents                | Student-controlled | Only a named official reviewer or authorized support role, if shared              | Reuse for model training, unrelated student comparisons         |

| Data type                         | Default state                 | When staff can access                                        | Staff should not receive                              |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Credit-comparison estimate        | Private planning result       | Shared only as part of a review packet                       | Presentation as an official transfer-credit decision  |
| Official credit-evaluation result | Institution-controlled record | Authorized records/advising roles under institutional policy | Modification by Semester, staff outside defined roles |
| Peer-mentor participation         | Private by default            | Program coordinator sees minimum operational status          | Transcript, grades, aid status, accommodation details |

**Design rule:** Staff see only what is necessary to perform the selected workflow. A transfer advisor may need a student-shared agenda and the documents needed for review; they do not need the student's complete private planning history, other community memberships, or AI chats.

## Career and workforce module

Career tools should maximize student control because career data can become sensitive or commercially valuable.

| Data type                              | Default state           | Permitted sharing                                                          | Prohibited sharing                                      |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Goals, target roles, skill reflections | Private                 | Student-selected advisor/mentor view                                       | Employers by default; hidden profiling                  |
| Portfolio artifacts                    | Private                 | Student selects item, audience, duration, and permission                   | Automatic publication or employer access                |
| Resume/application drafts              | Private                 | Student explicitly requests career-center or mentor feedback               | Employer access without submission                      |
| Opportunity saves and applications     | Private                 | Aggregate institutional reporting only, unless student requests assistance | Sale to recruiters; academic surveillance               |
| Verified credentials                   | Student-controlled      | Export/share through student action                                        | Revoke or alter verified records without issuer process |
| Academic records                       | Not required by default | Only through a separately authorized, clearly explained workflow           | Employer discovery, talent ranking, advertising         |

The system should distinguish student self-claims, reflections, verified participation, verified contribution, assessed competencies, and issuer credentials. That preserves credibility and lets students decide how to represent their work.

## Basic-Needs Navigator

This is the highest-sensitivity module. Treat browsing for food, housing, emergency aid, health, childcare, technology, or safety resources as private.

| User action              | Staff visibility | Minimum data practice                                |
|--------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Browse a resource        | None by default  | Do not create a staff-visible case or alert          |
| Save a private checklist | None             | Store only in the student workspace; permit deletion |

| User action                       | Staff visibility                                      | Minimum data practice                                         |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ask an informational question     | No case unless student requests referral              | Provide a source-labeled answer and official route            |
| Request appointment/referral      | Only named receiving office/case manager              | Collect minimum required fields and explicit consent          |
| Complete official intake          | Managed by the official service system where possible | Semester stores referral status, not sensitive intake detail  |
| Use emergency/campus-safety route | Follow institution-approved emergency policy          | Do not market this as crisis monitoring or emergency response |

A basic-needs hub should include institution-verified resources, public-benefits information where appropriate, emergency-aid routes, and a clear human navigator. The Hope Center recommends centralizing resource information and connecting students to supports such as food, housing, benefits, health care, technology, transportation, hygiene, and childcare. [<sup>1564</sup>1583]

## AI assistant

AI should be context-limited and privacy-preserving by default.

Private AI mode:

The student's interaction is private and not visible to staff.

Course AI mode:

Use only the course's approved sources and policy; do not expose conversation content to instructors unless the student intentionally shares an artifact.

Institutional navigator mode:

Use official, curated resource information; do not send the student's question to an office unless they explicitly request a referral or handoff.

Support mode:

Share only the minimum information needed to resolve the requested support issue, with a named support role, purpose, and time-limited access.

Do not use AI conversations to infer mental-health status, financial distress, disability, academic risk, immigration status, or misconduct risk. Do not train general-purpose models on institutional or student content unless a documented agreement, authorization, and technical controls permit it.

## What staff can see

Use a **minimum-necessary, role-based, purpose-bound** model. Staff should not have a universal "student 360" profile.

Default staff dashboard

For many offices, the appropriate view is operational and aggregate:

Resource page ownership and freshness  
Broken links and content issues  
Aggregate searches with small-cell suppression  
Aggregate referral volume  
Appointment demand  
Referral completion status, if needed operationally  
Anonymized feedback themes  
Accessibility issues reported  
Service-level performance

This lets a basic-needs office improve access without knowing who merely looked for food assistance.

Student-specific staff views

Student-specific data should appear only when all of these are true:

1. The office has a defined institutional function.
2. The person has a role that needs the data.
3. The data is necessary for the specific task.
4. The student has explicitly initiated/shared the workflow, or another documented institutional/legal basis applies.
5. The screen limits data to the relevant case or referral.
6. The access is logged, reviewable, and time-bounded where appropriate.

Example role matrix

| Role                       | Can see                                                                                                   | Cannot see                                                                              |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Transfer advisor           | Student-shared agenda, selected documents, unresolved questions, official evaluation status if authorized | Private plans, unrelated community activity, basic-needs browsing, private AI history   |
| Registrar/credit evaluator | Official evaluation packet and required documents                                                         | Career goals, mentoring conversations, private notes                                    |
| Career counselor           | Student-shared resume, portfolio, career goals, selected applications                                     | Grades, aid details, basic-needs activity, private academic AI chats                    |
| Basic-needs case manager   | Minimum referral information and case-specific intake through the authorized system                       | Full transcript, club membership, mentor conversations, unrelated transfer documents    |
| Faculty member             | Course-authorized material and explicitly shared academic work                                            | Basic-needs requests, career records, accommodation diagnosis, private account activity |
| Club officer               | Membership and event-related information required for the organization                                    | Academic record, aid status, mentoring cases, safety case details                       |

| Role             | Can see                                              | Cannot see                                                            |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moderator        | Only content and evidence attached to assigned cases | Broad private-message browsing, academic record, transfer/aid history |
| Platform support | Time-limited, approved technical context             | Unrestricted content access, case details outside the support request |

### Data-sharing control screen

Before a share, show:

You are sharing:  
Transfer-credit question list and two course syllabi

With:  
Taylor Nguyen, Transfer Credit Evaluator, Registrar’s Office

Purpose:  
Review your official transfer-credit evaluation

Access:  
View-only

Expires:  
December 15, 2026

Not included:  
Private notes, other uploaded documents, AI conversations, career workspace, club memberships, and basic-needs activity

You can:  
Cancel before submission / edit selection / revoke future access where permitted

This makes student agency tangible and reduces inadvertent over-sharing.

### Liability and risk controls

Semester cannot eliminate institutional or company liability through disclaimers alone. It needs accurate product boundaries, technical controls, documented operating procedures, contracts, insurance, and trained people. Legal counsel should tailor these controls by jurisdiction, institution, and service type.

#### 1. Clear authority boundaries

Every relevant interface should state whether information is:

Institution verified  
Published policy  
Student provided  
Semester estimate  
AI generated

Needs official review  
Emergency information

Use conspicuous boundaries for high-risk domains:

Transfer credit:

“Semester organizes information and helps prepare questions. Only the authorized institution can determine official transfer credit.”

Financial aid:

“Semester is not a financial-aid determination system. Confirm eligibility, awards, and deadlines with the official financial-aid office.”

Career:

“Semester helps you prepare and organize opportunities. It does not guarantee employment or share your information with employers without your direction.”

Basic needs:

“Semester can help you find resources. It is not an emergency, medical, mental-health, legal, or crisis-response service.”

AI:

“AI can help explain and organize information. Verify important decisions with official sources or qualified people.”

## 2. Purpose limitation and data minimization

For each feature, maintain a data-processing register:

Feature  
Business owner  
Student purpose  
Institutional purpose  
Data fields  
Sensitive-data category  
Legal/contractual basis  
Who can access  
Retention period  
Deletion/export process  
Subprocessors  
Cross-border/residency location  
Security controls  
Risk rating  
Approval date

If a field does not support a defined purpose, do not collect it.

### 3. Consent and appropriate authorization

Use consent for optional student-controlled sharing, optional mentoring, optional employer visibility, and optional communication preferences. Do not use “consent” as a substitute for institutional obligations or legal requirements.

For institution-provided data, use the appropriate contractual and institutional authorization model. FERPA allows a school-official exception under specific conditions, including direct control over outsourced services, use only for the disclosed purpose, redisclosure limits, and alignment with institutional annual-notice criteria. [\[2\]](#) [\[1\]](#)

### 4. High-risk workflow controls

| Risk area                        | Required control                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Incorrect transfer guidance      | Official-source labels, freshness dates, uncertainty display, human evaluator handoff, no official-decision claims |
| Misleading AI output             | Source grounding, limitations, policy checks, report path, evaluation, human escalation                            |
| Student distress or emergency    | Emergency notice, approved official routes, no promise of emergency monitoring, trained escalation policy          |
| Sensitive basic-needs disclosure | Private browsing, minimum intake, named recipient, consented referral, restricted case access                      |
| Employer misuse                  | Student opt-in, artifact-level sharing, no academic/behavioral data access, anti-spam rules, audit logs            |
| Discrimination/bias              | Accessibility testing, bias evaluation, human review, appeal/correction route, aggregate monitoring                |
| Harassment/community harm        | Block/mute/report, moderator training, case controls, evidence and appeal process                                  |
| Data breach                      | Encryption, MFA, least privilege, detection, response plan, notification procedure, tested recovery                |
| Service failure/outage           | Status page, redundancy, backups, manual fallback, incident communications, SLA/SLO controls                       |
| Staff misuse                     | Role separation, least privilege, access logs, periodic review, anomaly alerts, sanctions/training                 |

### 5. AI governance model

Use NIST AI RMF as the operating structure:

**GOVERN:**  
Assign owners, policies, risk appetite, training, vendor controls, documentation, accountability, and escalation.

**MAP:**  
Document the AI use case, people affected, context, inputs, outputs, harm scenarios, accessibility needs, and institutional boundaries.

**MEASURE:**  
Test accuracy, grounding, bias, safety, privacy, security, hallucinations,

prompt injection, accessibility, user understanding, and failure modes.

**MANAGE:**

Apply controls, monitor, respond to incidents, change/disable features, maintain records, and improve based on evidence.

NIST's Generative AI Profile provides a practical companion to the AI RMF for managing generative-AI risks across the lifecycle. NIST AI 800-1's public drafts focus on identifying, measuring, and mitigating misuse risk associated with dual-use foundation models; treat it as a voluntary risk-management input, while checking the current publication status before citing a final standard in contractual language. [<sup>1574</sup>]<sup>[3]</sup> <sup>[4]</sup>

## 6. Safety and escalation boundaries

For basic needs, mentorship, community, and AI interactions:

Show emergency guidance prominently when relevant.  
Use institution-configured official emergency contacts and service routes.  
Train moderators, support staff, mentors, and operators in boundaries and escalation.  
Do not require a student to explain sensitive circumstances to access general resources.  
Do not imply active monitoring of private activity.  
Do not promise response times or intervention capabilities you cannot meet.  
Preserve evidence only when necessary and according to retention/legal-hold policy.

## 7. Contracts, insurance, and evidence

Institutional contracts should clearly define:

Roles: institution as education-record owner/controller where applicable;  
Semester as service provider/processor as applicable.

Permitted data use and prohibited secondary use.  
Security controls, subprocessor management, and breach notice.  
Support and incident-response responsibilities.  
Accessibility commitments and remediation process.  
AI providers, training/data-use rules, and policy configuration.  
Data export, deletion, retention, legal holds, and offboarding.  
Indemnity, liability caps, exclusions, and insurance requirements.  
Content ownership, intellectual property, and copyright/takedown process.  
Institution responsibilities for source accuracy, policy configuration, moderation ownership, and emergency routing.

Maintain an evidence register so you can demonstrate—not merely claim—compliance:

Access-review reports  
Penetration-test and vulnerability evidence  
Backup and recovery tests  
Incident exercises  
AI evaluations and safety testing  
Accessibility test results and remediation

Subprocessor reviews  
Data-deletion/export tests  
Training completion  
Moderation and escalation drills  
Policy approvals and change history

## Practical launch gates

Do not enable a module for a tenant until it passes these gates:

Named institutional business owner.  
Approved purpose, scope, audience, and authority boundary.  
Data map and retention schedule.  
Role/permission matrix tested.  
Privacy notice and student-facing disclosure reviewed.  
Accessibility acceptance tests passed.  
Human handoff and emergency/escalation route configured.  
Content owner, source freshness, and review date assigned.  
AI policy and provider settings approved, if AI is enabled.  
Support runbook, incident process, and escalation contacts tested.  
Audit logging, export, deletion, and revocation paths verified.  
Contract/DPA/security obligations mapped to implemented controls.

The benchmark outcome is a platform where staff receive just enough information to provide help, students retain control over private exploration and optional sharing, and Semester never mistakes a need for help as permission to monitor or judge a student.

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